



TMC221

Lecture **4**

Systems for Sustainable Success

w/ Azubuike **EZENWOKE, PhD**



Why Success Needs a System

Luck vs. Cause and Effect

Shallow men think of luck, but wise and strong men believe in cause and effect. — **Ralph Waldo Emerson**

Success is not **Accidental**. It runs on a **system**:

- A system is parts working together to deliver a guaranteed result
- Hard work without a system is an engine with no transmission
- When the seven kits are assembled, success becomes a harvest

The 7 Kits at a Glance

The Task System is made up of seven interlocking kits:

- **Task** — Am I bound to this?
- **Training** — Am I equipped?
- **Target** — Where exactly am I going?
- **Tools** — What do I need in my hand?
- **Timing** — When do I step out?
- **Tillage** — Am I working?
- **Tarrying** — Will I wait for it?

Remove one kit,
the engine
sputters. Install
all 7, success
becomes
inevitable.

Kit 1 — Task

Necessity Is Laid Upon Me

Woe is unto me, if I preach not the gospel!
— **1 Cor 9:16**

Until you see your **assignment** as a necessity:

- It will never enjoy your best
- You will never get the best out of it
- You function as one merely attempting, not accomplishing

Necessity is the mother of **Invention** — and **Invention** is the mother of **Distinction**.

Attempt vs. Task

Two Mindsets, Two Outcomes

Attempt	Task
Let me try this"	This must work"
Retreat is an option	No retreat available
Dies at first resistance	Outlasts opposition
Ends in retirement	Ends in triumph

If you are going out to try, you may die in trials. Rather, make your quest a necessity.

The Bond of Necessity

Lessons from History and Scripture

Nigeria Civil War: "To keep Nigeria one is a task that must be done." Every resource was channeled to the task.

- **Apostle Paul:** "For to me to live is Christ, and to die is gain." (Phil. 1:21)
- **Dr. Oyedepo's own covenant:** "Lord, should I pretend not to have heard You, see to it that I don't succeed in any other thing I do."

Bind yourself by necessity — or die in bondage.



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Kit 2 — Training

Quality of Training = Degree of Triumph

“Abram armed his **trained** servants... and pursued them unto Dan.” — **Gen 14:14**

Two forms of training:

- **Formal** — received from educational institutions; sets the pace
- **Informal (Personal Development)** — delivers the goods

Many are schooled. Few are trained.
Training is proof of **Personal Commitment.**



Giants Built by Personal Development

Qualification Is No Substitute — Nor Disqualifier

God requires that one first be trained before he is placed. Your **Training** determines your **Placement**.

- **Benjamin Franklin** — stopped school at age 10. Became inventor, diplomat, framer of the U.S. Constitution, founder of the Uni of Pennsylvania
- **Richard Branson** — school drop-out turned Virgin empire founder. Not a brain drop-out
- **Anthony Robbins** — high school education only. Now teaches professors
- **Oral Roberts** — high school only. Founded a leading Christian University

Kit 3 — Target

Certainty of Goal

“If you don't have a goal, you will live like a goat, looking for the path of least resistance.”
— **Dr. David Oyedepo**

A target must be:

- **Specific** — not vague
- **Defined** — clearly described
- **Quantifiable** — measurable progress
- **Yours** — born of your own calling

To live without a target is to end up in tears.

Running a Vision With Precision

No Goalpost, No Game

How anointed or talented you are notwithstanding — **without a goal, you cannot score one.**

- A football match without **goalposts** never ends
- Without a **target**, you copy what is **popular**
- Your friend starts a crusade — you join; another opens a shop — you follow; a third returns to school — you enrol. **You end up disjointed**
- **Always ask:** *"What am I actually after?"*

Stop fighting
as one beating
the air. Run
with the tape
as your target.

Kit 4 — Tools

The Right Instrument for the Job

Going after a task without tools is like going to **war without arms**.

Ask yourself:

"What will I need to accomplish my goal?"

- The Bible for the minister
- Industry books and mentors for the entrepreneur
- Specific equipment for the specific craft
- Works of proven leaders in your chosen field

Acquire the
Tools — no
matter the
cost.

Wisdom from the Spanner & the King

Two Pictures That Make It Plain

- **The Spanner** — try loosening a bolt with your bare hands. You will bleed and sweat, but the bolt will not move. There is a particular tool for the job.
- **The King** — "What king, going to make war against another king, sitteth not down first, and consulteth whether he be able?" (Luke 14:31)
- **Dr. Oyedepo's own example:** preparing a motivational drive across Africa, he first gathered the works of **Norman Vincent Peale** and **Robert Schuller**.

Equip the **hand**
before you attempt
the **harvest**.

Kit 5 — Timing

Commanders Understand the Times

"To every thing there is a season, and a time to every purpose under the heaven." — **Ecc 3:1**

- **Jesus at Cana:** "*Mine hour is not yet come.*" (John 2:4)
- **Jesus and Lazarus:** He abode two more days. Timing produced resurrection, not mere healing
- **The seasonal business:** selling iced water on a cold rainy day is a dead business on arrival

Right timing is a major asset.
Until the time is ripe, do not step out.



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How to Discern Timing

Sensitivity Is the Skill

Timing has two edges: starting too early, and waiting too long. Both are failures of discernment.

4 Practical Disciplines for Reading your Season:

- **Ask God sincerely** — approach Him with a clear heart
- **Remove distractions** — stand before Him expecting to hear
- **Be sensitive to your environment** — resources are often right in your room
- **Once green-lit, refuse contrary thoughts** — God provides when He commands

Kit 6 — Tillage

Put Your Hands to Work

Hard work never kills; it only refines.
Nothing kills like idleness.

The future of any assignment is determined by the **Quality** of your labour input.

- **The Foolish Farmer** — throws seed on unploughed ground, harvests nothing
- **The Oil Well** — no drill, no oil; everything precious requires pressure
- **The Teaching Tent** — start with two people; they will tell two more

He that tilleth
his land shall
be satisfied
with bread." —
Pro 12:11

Create Work, Don't Wait for It

Disciplined Labour Beats Raw Effort

Tillage is not **random activity** — it is **disciplined, planned labour**:

- Do not wait for perfect conditions
- Break your target into daily, doable actions
- **Prepare in Advance** (Winners prepares a full month's messages before the month begins)
- Create work for yourself — do not wait for work to find you

By much slothfulness the building decayeth; and through idleness of the hands the house droppeth through."
— **Ecc 10:18**"

Kit 7 — Tarrying

Success Is Not a Seven-Day Wonder

God runs a **Due-season Calendar**.

When you are due, He will not deny you

Between planted seed and gathered harvest, there is always a waiting period.

- Rome was not built in a day
- A child born at six months is premature
- Every great manifestation requires a gestation period

“Though it tarry, wait for it; because it will surely come, it will not tarry.” — **Hab 2:3**

The Sledgehammer and Jericho

The Cumulative Effect of Faithfulness

Your current blows are weakening the wall. **Do Not Stop.**

- **The Wall:** A man with a sledgehammer can't quit after one blow—the wall falls at the 50th, but it's the result of all 49 before it
- **Jericho:** Israel marched for six days and nothing happened. On the seventh day, the walls fell. Same process. Different timing.

When results tarry:

- Do not give up
- Re-examine the kits; repair anything out of place
- Wait for the manifestation

Conclusion

Your 7-Point Self-Audit — Over to You

- **Task** — bound by necessity?
- **Training** — developing daily?
- **Target** — stated in one sentence?
- **Tools** — in your hand?
- **Timing** — the right season?
- **Tillage** — hands to the work?
- **Tarrying** — waiting with endurance?

For the assignment most alive in your heart, answer **Yes**, **Partly**, or **No**:

Thank You
Questions *and*
Comments

